JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 12 years of experience building and scaling backend systems across fintech and healthcare sectors. I've led technical architecture decisions for services handling millions of transactions daily, mentored junior engineers through complex problem-solving, and consistently shipped high-impact projects that improved system reliability and reduced operational costs. I enjoy working on distributed systems challenges and helping teams navigate the tradeoffs between performance, maintainability, and velocity.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Nexus Financial Systems (nexusfinance.io)

London, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

- Architected and implemented a real-time transaction processing pipeline that reduced settlement latency from 8 hours to under 2 minutes, directly improving customer experience for 50,000+ active traders

- Established engineering standards and code review practices across 6 backend teams, increasing test coverage from 64% to 92% and reducing production incidents by 38%

- Led migration of legacy monolithic payment service to microservices, mentoring three junior engineers through the redesign process and delivering the project 2 weeks ahead of schedule

- Designed and deployed monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, enabling faster incident response and reducing MTTR by 45%

Senior Software Engineer

DataFlow Insights Ltd (dataflowinsights.co)

London, United Kingdom

July 2017 - February 2021

- Developed distributed data pipeline processing 2 billion events daily using Apache Spark and Python, reducing compute costs by 34% through optimization of shuffle operations

- Implemented machine learning model serving infrastructure using GPT-4 API and custom REST endpoints, supporting real-time predictions for customer segmentation tasks

- Built data validation framework that caught 99.2% of upstream data quality issues before they reached analytics layer, saving 200+ hours of manual debugging annually

- Mentored four engineers on system design principles and led knowledge-sharing sessions on distributed consensus algorithms

Senior Backend Engineer

ClinicalTech Solutions Ltd (clinicaltech.net)

London, United Kingdom

September 2012 - June 2017

- Designed and maintained REST APIs handling 10 million requests daily across healthcare compliance systems, achieving 99.97% uptime over 5-year period

- Implemented uv package management across 12 microservices, improving build times by 60% and reducing dependency conflicts significantly

- Developed automated compliance audit logging system using PostgreSQL and event sourcing patterns, reducing manual audit preparation time from 5 days to 4 hours

- Collaborated with DevOps team to establish CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to 12 minutes per release

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend Development: Python, Java, Go, SQL, REST APIs, GraphQL, Event-Driven Architecture

Data Technologies: Apache Spark, PostgreSQL, Redis, Apache Kafka, Elasticsearch

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda, S3), Google Cloud Platform

DevOps and Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab CI

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Methodologies: Microservices Architecture, Domain-Driven Design, TDD, Agile